

Asus Zenbook Duo 2026

Panther Lake makes this the best multitasking laptop

The Asus Zenbook Duo 2026, a 14-inch laptop that feels like it shouldn't really work as a daily driver, but somehow does. For the longest time, I have used laptops like most people use laptops. Then the Asus Zenbook Duo UX8407 arrived.

I'll be honest, I wasn't immediately sold. I remember when a colleague tested the previous UX8406 almost two years ago; it looked like a nice experiment, but it still felt a bit 'first-gen'. Don't get me wrong, Asus has been using the Zenbook Duo moniker for quite a few years, and back in 2021, I even used one of the initial models. But that one was nothing like this one we are talking about right here.

This 2026 refresh is the first time I've actually lived with a 'proper' dual-screen setup myself, and it's a big shift. After having used the Zenbook Duo, I can say that this isn't just a gimmick strapped onto a laptop; it's how I actually want to get through my workday. Also, knowing the fact that my review unit will be returned soon, going back to a single screen feels a bit like trying to work with one hand tied behind my back.

THE HINGE AND THE 'SEAM' PROBLEM

The biggest issue with dual-screen laptops has always been the physical gap between the panels. If you're going to give me two displays, they need to feel like one, and not like two tablets awkwardly stuck together, if you know what I mean. This is where the UX8407 really steps up. Asus has designed the hinge



in such a way that the two 14-inch panels sit almost flush against each other.

When you use the built-in kickstand to stack the screens vertically, that gap is so small it basically disappears when you're focused on your content. It creates this tall viewing experience that is, quite frankly, addictive. I found myself snapping Chrome to the top and Docs to the bottom, and for the first time, I didn't feel like I was compromising on space. The build itself uses a Ceraluminum finish, which has this stony, matte feel that is much nicer than standard metal. The good thing is that it's tactile, resists the oily fingerprints that usually show up on other types of materials, and feels sturdy.

THOSE GORGEOUS (BUT REFLECTIVE) OLEDs

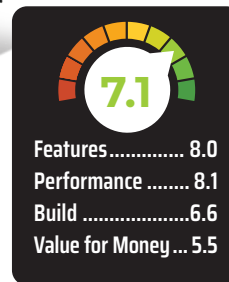
If you're going to spend what will likely be Rs 2-2.5 lakh for this Core Ultra 9

variant of the Zenbook Duo UX8407, the screens have to be the headline. Asus has gone all out with dual 14-inch Lumina Pro OLED touchscreen panels. They've bumped the refresh rate to 144Hz, which makes scrolling and animations feel incredibly smooth, actually smoother than the iPhone 17 Pro Max and the S26 Ultra I carry around.

The colour accuracy is professional-grade. In the Digit Test Labs, I ran a Calman test and got an Average Delta E of 1.02, which is basically perfect. It covers 100% of the DCI-P3 gamut, so watching anything on these screens – Netflix, YouTube, Prime or simply gawking at it – is a treat. The blacks are deep, and with 500 nits of brightness, the contrast is punchy. The only real downside is the reflection. Asus added an anti-reflective layer, which helps with overhead office lights, but these

are still glossy glass panels.

If you've got a bright light source or a window behind you, you're going to see your own reflection during dark movie scenes.



A KEYBOARD THAT DOESN'T FEEL LIKE AN AFTERTHOUGHT

One of my worries when the

Zenbook Duo first arrived was the keyboard. You see, usually when a laptop gets this 'creative' with the form factor, the typing experience suffers. Here, the keyboard is a detachable Bluetooth folio that sits between the screens when the laptop is closed. With this one, you can actually use it as a normal laptop, having the screen up top along with the keyboard. Or, you can use like me – sitting back, with both screens set like a tower, and using the keyboard propped on my lap or the table.

I've spent a good while typing out scripts and articles on this, and it's actually really nice. The keys have a good 1.4mm of travel and a 'mushy' feel in a good way, soft on the sound but tactile enough that I didn't miss my mechanical deck. It's quiet, so